

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Thank you for being here today.



Learning Outcome

Accurately use important information about people's jobs and places of work in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you like listening to presentations? Why or why not?
- What was the last presentation you listened to? What did you think of it?

Can Do Statements

- I can give a presentation.
- I can talk about what is acceptable and unacceptable.
- I can talk about appropriate behavior for jobs and work.





Let's Explore!

Miranda talks about **cultural differences***. What does she say?

* "Cultural differences" are the variations between cultures and what is and isn't acceptable in each.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Good job, everyone - that was fun! I thought I would begin with a simple exercise. Now we will consider cultural differences that can be more complicated.

Firstly, North Americans are expected to present their ideas in a formal and rational manner. At a business meeting, emotional speakers may be considered dishonest or unreliable. In contrast, South Americans may express their feelings about a fact more freely through the voice, word choice or body language.

Regarding punctuality, North Americans consider it inappropriate to be late for any meeting. They usually arrive shortly before the agreed time. It is appropriate to refuse to chat with a person one meets on the way because it is important not to keep anyone waiting. However, being dismissive may be offensive to Latinos.

My last point concerns ideas of honesty. North Americans value direct speech. For instance, it is acceptable for colleagues or employers to correct or disagree with one another, whereas a Latino may find this way of talking offensive. Unlike the North American, whose words must give a direct meaning, a Latino may interpret words for indirect meanings. North Americans may strengthen their meaning with expression, but, unlike the Latino, not contradict it.

In summary, it is important to understand cultural differences and expectations to prevent misunderstanding. Thank you for your attention. Now, the floor is open for questions.





Let's Practice!

What is acceptable and unacceptable to them?

Instructions: Read the presentation again. Write true or false.

- 1) North Americans consider it appropriate to be late for any meeting. _____
- 2) North Americans never arrive shortly before the agreed time. _____
- 3) In North America, it is inappropriate to refuse to chat with a person one meets on the way. _____
- 4) In North America, ideas need to be presented in an informal and rational manner. _____
- 5) Brushing people off may be offensive to Latinos. _____
- 6) It is acceptable for colleagues or employers to correct or disagree with one another in North America. _____



Let's Practice!

Miranda uses quite a few adjectives in her presentation.

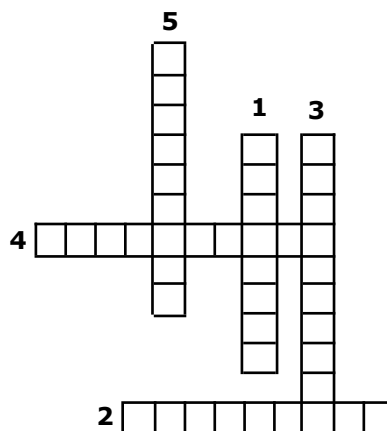
Instructions: Read the definitions. Complete the crossword.

DOWN

1. based on reasons rather than emotions
3. cannot be trusted or depended on
5. very rude or insulting and likely to upset people

ACROSS

2. not honest, deceiving or cheating people
4. not paying attention to; ignoring





Extension Activity

Let's present some of our ideas!

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Think of a process you might like to change in your workplace or school. Why do you think it needs to be changed?
- Write a short presentation of what process needs to be changed and how you'd like to change it.
- Make your presentation about 70 - 80 words.
- Be sure to use the language necessary for a presentation.
- Proofread your presentation.
- Read your presentation aloud to a partner.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I understand and use language necessary for a presentation.

☐
☐

I write a short presentation about something I would like to change.

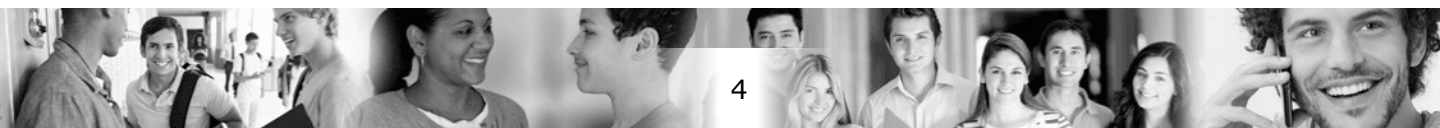
☐
☐

I deliver my presentation to a partner.

☐
☐


Target Words

- rational** (adjective): based on reasons rather than emotions
e.g. North Americans are expected to present their idea in a formal and rational manner.
- unreliable** (adjective): cannot be trusted or depended on
e.g. Emotional speakers may be considered unreliable.
- dishonest** (adjective): not honest, deceiving or cheating people
e.g. At a business meeting, emotional speakers may be considered dishonest or unreliable.
- in contrast** (expression): the opposite; compared to something else
e.g. In contrast to North Americans, South Americans express their feelings more freely.
- dismissive** (verb): not paying attention to; ignoring
e.g. In the Latin culture, being dismissive is considered offensive.
- whereas** (conjunction): used to compare two facts
e.g. It is acceptable in the US for colleagues to disagree with one another, whereas a Latino may agree with their colleague.
- offensive** (adjective): very rude or insulting and likely to upset people
e.g. Asking them questions like that may be offensive.
- in summary** (expression): a short statement that gives only the main points of something, not the details
e.g. In summary, it is important to understand cultural differences and expectations to prevent misunderstanding.
- to prevent** (verb): to stop something from happening
e.g. Open communication prevents misunderstanding.
- the floor is open** (expression): to open discussion to everyone
e.g. Thank you for listening. Now, the floor is open for questions.





Learning Points

Giving a Presentation

It is important to sound professional and prepared when giving a business presentation. You will also need to become familiar with the structure and vocabulary needed for a presentation. Below, you will find language you can use to give, structure, organize, link and finish off your presentation.

1. Opening your presentation and introducing yourself

- I'd like to welcome everyone to the meeting.
- Thank you all for being here today.
- Thank you all for making it on such short notice.
- Shall we start?
- Let's start.
- My name is ... and I'm the ... for

1. Overview

- We're here to discuss ...
- The purpose of this presentation is to ...
- The objective of this presentation is to ...
- The main subject of this meeting is to ...
- May I invite you to ask any questions at the end of the presentation? Thank you.

1. Giving an overview

- Let me begin by presenting a short outline of my talk.
- First, I will talk about ...
- Then, I'll outline a ...
- After that, I will discuss ...
- Finally, I will discuss ...

(notice the adverbial linking phrases)

1. Stating important points

- There are a number of problems associated with ...
- In the first place, .../Firstly, ...
- Secondly, ... /In contrast, ...
- Another problem is ... /On the other hand, ...
- Furthermore, ...
- Another advantage is ... All in all, ... /In summary, ...

1. Closing and questions

- OK then. To sum up ...
- Right. In summary ...
- Now the floor is open for questions ...





Learning Points

- Now, if there are any questions ...

Talking About What is Acceptable or Unacceptable

In the business world, there's a close connection between culture and social behavior.

Different cultures have different patterns of social behavior. What might be acceptable in some cultures may be perceived as being acceptable or unacceptable in other cultures. Here are patterns you can use to talk about what is acceptable or unacceptable.

Examples:

- *North Americans are expected to be on time.*
- *It is inappropriate for South Americans not to express their feelings.*
- *South Americans usually express their feelings more openly.*
- *North Americans consider it inappropriate to be late for a meeting.*
- *Emotional speakers are considered unreliable.*
- *Feelings are not expressed during meetings.*

